

a more collaborative leadership style. I introduced the RACI framework (Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, and Informed) into PGI's academic and operational structure, which has helped streamline processes and improve accountability across all levels. This shift has allowed us to be more agile and responsive to changes, ensuring that we stay ahead of the competition. I have always pushed for innovation—particularly in adapting to the rapidly evolving K-12 and collegiate sectors. Additionally, we are studying the potential for expanding beyond Karnataka, with the possibility of establishing a Deemed-to-be University, subject to the approval of relevant authorities. It's about stepping forward with a fresh perspective while respecting the values and strengths we've always had.

PGI is close to completing 50 golden years of its establishment. What are the plans that you would unveil for the celebratory year?

As we approach this monumental milestone, the 50th anniversary of PGI represents not just a reflection on our achievements, but also an exciting opportunity to look ahead. The journey has been remarkable, but the future is where the real promise lies. We have always believed that PGI is one big family, and every person who contributes to its success is an equal stakeholder in its legacy. For this celebratory year, we want to bring that family spirit alive by hosting grand alumni reunions across all our institutions. These events will not only honour the past but also showcase how far we've come and the incredible community that we've built together. We'll also be unveiling new initiatives that reflect our vision for the next 50 years, ensuring that PGI continues to lead in shaping the future of education.

You have set an example that anything can be achieved by a woman if she has set her heart to it. How true does it stand in your life as one at the helm of an educational institution in a male-dominated sector?

For me, leadership has always been about vision, resilience, and determination. My journey has been deeply influenced by the values instilled in me by my father, Dr. Nissar Ahmed, who has always believed in the transformative power of education. As a woman leading in a sector traditionally dominated by men, I've learned to challenge norms, inspire others, and foster an inclusive culture that encourages growth for all. It's not just about setting an example for other women, but also about empowering those around me to embrace their potential. The road has never been easy, but it has been incredibly rewarding. I believe that with the right mindset and a commitment to breaking barriers, women can lead and transform any field, just as we are doing at PGI.

When you took on the mantle as Director of PGI schools, what were the challenges that

you encountered in giving new direction to the institutions?

Taking on the leadership of PGI schools, was a significant responsibility that required both courage and conviction. The challenge wasn't just in carrying forward his legacy but also in infusing my own vision for the future. I sought to create an educational environment that was more than just about academics — one that prepares students to lead with innovation, empathy, and global perspectives. Another challenge was transitioning the institutions to embrace modern educational tools and practices while preserving the core values that PGI was built upon. Balancing these two aspects — tradition and innovation — required careful thought and collaboration at every level.

What are the steps taken by you to make education at PGI of global quality and standards?

At PGI, our mission is to constantly evolve and keep pace with global educational standards. We've integrated cutting-edge technologies, including AI, robotics, and data-driven learning methods, into our curriculum to ensure that our students are prepared for the future workforce. We have also formed strategic partnerships with renowned international institutions to offer students global exposure, which enhances their academic and cultural experiences. Our faculty development programs are regularly updated to reflect the latest teaching methodologies, ensuring that our educators are equipped to lead in the classroom. Additionally, we have implemented infrastructure that focuses on sustainability and innovation, making PGI a dynamic environment for growth and learning.

What is the emphasis that is given to students where focus is given to their holistic development and the outcomes thereof?

At PGI, we believe in nurturing students holistically, not just academically but also in terms of emotional intelligence, leadership, and social responsibility. Our curriculum is designed to encourage critical thinking, creativity, and practical problem-solving skills. We place a strong emphasis on experiential learning — programs like Model United Nations (MUN), internships, and leadership training provide students with opportunities to develop communication skills, teamwork, and global awareness. Additionally, we focus on Social and Emotional Learning (SEL) to foster mental well-being and ethical development. These programs prepare students not just to excel in their careers, but also to become responsible, empathetic leaders capable of making a positive impact on society.

What are your future plans for PGI schools in terms of collaborations with foreign institutions and the industry?

As we look to the future, my vision for PGI is to strengthen our ties with global institutions and industries to provide our students with unparalleled opportunities for growth. We are expanding

Dr. Salman Ahmed, Vice President of Presidency University, an iconic youth entrepreneur and a 'go to' person on the PGI campuses. His Teachup programme, where students from the Presidency University mentor students in Government schools in Karnataka, entirely his concept, is a unique example of building strong synergies among the youth and a robust campus with all the freedom to explore and excel in academics and beyond.



■ Mr. Salman Ahmed
Vice President
Presidency University

our collaborations with prestigious universities worldwide to facilitate exchange programs, joint research, and student internships. Furthermore, we are establishing stronger industry partnerships to offer hands-on learning opportunities in emerging fields such as AI, data science, and entrepreneurship. Our goal is to create innovation hubs where students can engage in real-world projects, and gain the necessary skills and experience to thrive in today's competitive job market. We want PGI graduates to be not just academically proficient, but also industry-ready professionals with a global mind-set.

How much credit would you give to family values, and who is your inspiration that has shaped you as an individual with a stellar professional identity?

Family values have been the cornerstone of my personal and professional identity. Growing up in a